# *‘Ridiculously high’: Trump’s Hormuz toll would send energy prices skyrocketing, analysts warn*

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‘Ridiculously high’: Trump’s Hormuz toll would send energy prices skyrocketing, analysts warn
By Carlos Anchondo, James Bikales · Jul 14, 2026, 6:46 AM · View in your browser

President Donald Trump’s plan to impose 20 percent fees on ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz would jack up the cost of oil — if it even could be practically implemented, analysts said.

The new Hormuz charge would pose a fresh challenge to Republicans’ efforts to bring down gas prices ahead of the midterm elections. It would also be another blow to oil markets that have been under strain since the U.S. and Israel first launched attacks against Iran in February, only appearing in recent weeks to be returning to normal under the U.S. and Iran’s now-abandoned ceasefire.

Trump on Monday pronounced the United States the “guardian” of the strait, through which one-fifth of the world’s crude moved prior to the war. Trump said the U.S. would reimpose the blockade on Iranian exports it had maintained for two months earlier in the conflict and declared that the U.S. would be reimbursed “at the rate of 20% on all cargo shipped, for any and all costs necessary to do the job of providing safety and security to this very volatile section of the World.”

U.S. Central Command said on social media that the blockade would take effect Tuesday at 4 p.m. Eastern Time and it would continue to “support traffic flow” of vessels not traveling to and from Iranian ports.

The U.S. benchmark crude price jumped more than 9 percent on Monday to roughly $78 a barrel, reversing weeks of declines. Gas prices take several days to reflect changes in crude prices, but also appear to be once again on the rise .

Rory Johnston, an oil analyst who writes the newsletter Commodity Context, said a 20 percent fee on Hormuz transits would likely add $16 a barrel to the cost of shipping crude, calling it “ridiculously high.” The increase in insurance costs that deterred many shippers from transiting the Hormuz early in the conflict was only 5 percent, while Iran’s planned fee for the waterway amounted to around $1 a barrel, Johnston noted.

Iran Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi picked up on that discrepancy, posting on X that ship owners would actually save money with Tehran’s proposed fee over Trump’s proposal. The U.S. toll is “too much,” Abbas Araghchi said.

Trump is “absolutely right,” Abbas Araghchi said in the post. ”Whoever provides secure and safe passage of commercial vessels through the Strait of Hormuz should be compensated for this service. Iran has always been the GUARDIAN of the Strait and will remain so FOREVER.”

The White House didn't respond to questions on how it would enforce a toll on cargo passing through the strait and how the charge would affect oil prices. Voters rank cost-of-living concerns as top of their minds, polls show, and even Trump supporters are pinning at least part of the blame on the White House.

Research firm ClearView Energy Partners said the fee at current oil prices could add 37 cents a gallon to the cost of gasoline, and would amount to an "enormous" deterrent to oil production.

"Even if such fees eventually promoted pipeline bypasses to the Strait and greater demand for Western Hemisphere resources, in the near-to-intermediate term, they could strangle trade and spread inflation," ClearView said.

Experts said it's unclear what jurisdiction the United States would use to implement the charge, as well as what the toll would cover.

"Another question would be how?" said Bjorn Vang Jensen, executive industry adviser at Xeneta, a shipping analytics firm. "20 percent of what? 20 percent of the cargo value? 20 percent of the cargo plus the vessel value? There's precedents for that, but you'd have to go back to the early 1800s to find it."

Details about the U.S. fee on cargoes "remain to be seen and clarified," said Simon Wong, portfolio manager at investment firm Gabelli Funds. "I believe all of this is posturing and brinkmanship."

Still, oil industry reaction was fairly muted on Monday.

The American Petroleum Institute said it's still looking at the effect of renewed Middle East tensions. "Restoring the free and uninterrupted flow of energy through the Strait of Hormuz remains essential to stabilizing global markets, easing supply pressures and helping lower energy costs for consumers," API spokesperson Andrea Woods said in a statement.

Last month, API CEO Mike Sommers said the trade group would be "adamantly opposed to any tolling in the Strait of Hormuz, as we would in any other choke point in the world."

Edith Naegele, president and CEO of the Independent Petroleum Association of America, said in a statement that its members are focused on how they can "strengthen U.S. energy security and provide dependable supplies to global markets."

"Independent producers are price takers, not price makers, and they seek stability—not volatility—to support responsible planning, investment, and production," Naegele said.

Oliver Ward contributed to this report.

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